GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Spanish Language and Literature I · 1st year of Bachillerato · How we understand each other · Class 5 of 7 · With Vera

Tú, usted and register

Class video: https://youtu.be/uqbMtk2YVfk

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The class is about Spanish, so the examples stay in Spanish, with their meaning in English in brackets.

Before you start: tú or usted?

How would you address each of these people? Tick one box in each row, without thinking about it too much.

Person	Tú	Usted
Your grandmother		
Your Spanish Language teacher		
A doctor in her fifties, at the surgery		
A shop assistant, a young man of about twenty, in a shop		
A man of about seventy who asks you the way to a street		
The head teacher of your school		

Choose a row where you hesitated and explain in one sentence why you ticked what you ticked.

At the end of the class. What weighed most in each choice: the person's age, their position or how close you are? Is it what the class calls power or what it calls solidarity? And what can't be concluded from the

count for the whole class?

While you watch the video

1. (0:28) In the interviews from class 3, who did they use usted with? Answer before Vera says it.

2. (2:56) Vera asks: if both messages were fine, what is speaking well? Write your answer in one line and keep it until the end.

3. (3:45) We say «usted tiene», not «usted tienes». Why? Write your hypothesis while the countdown runs. Afterwards: what has «su majestad» ("Your Majesty") got to do with it?

4. (5:12–5:59) Draw the power semantic and the solidarity semantic with arrows. Which one is Sancho and Don Quixote's? And two friends'?

5. (6:19) Before the answer: out of nineteen older people from villages, how many do you think addressed their parents as usted? _____ . Afterwards: why aren't nineteen voices enough to speak for the whole of Spain, and which source do they agree with?

6. (7:11–8:00) In 55 of the 76 interviews, who uses usted with whom? What happens to the fieldworker in Errigoiti when the woman asks her to use tú?

7. (8:04–8:42) Which face from class 4 does tú look after, and which does usted? Give an example of each one going wrong.

8. (9:18–10:27) Field, tenor and mode: which question does each one answer? Which one do distance, public or private, the channel and the purpose go in? At the countdown at 10:27, note down two things that change if you send the group message to your teacher. Afterwards: which register marker does each one belong to?

9. (12:22–13:56) «Vale» ("OK") with a smile and «Vale» with an eye-roll: what does the emoji do in a chat that the face would do in person? And where does the "93%" come from, and what is it valid for, according to its own author?

10. (14:25) «Los eventos consuetudinarios que acontecen en la rúa» ("The consuetudinary occurrences that transpire upon the thoroughfare"): what would you write? Afterwards: is «Lo que pasa en la calle» ("What happens in the street") less formal?

Practice

1. A public-address announcement at a train station. Describe its situation: what it's about, who with whom, and by what means and what for. And point out two markers of its register.

2. Keep this sentence formal, but make it clear: «Le comunico que procederé a efectuar la entrega del trabajo en el día de mañana» ("I wish to inform you that I shall proceed to effect the submission of the assignment in the course of tomorrow"). Explain why the long version isn't more formal.

3. Tú or usted, and why? With your new neighbour, who's eighty; with your summer-camp leader, who's twenty-two; and in a job interview. Also say which face you look after in each case.

The examples on this worksheet are invented.

Keep thinking

A 46-year-old man, in an interview from 2010: «El respeto no está en el tratamiento» ("Respect isn't in the form of address") (ESLORA corpus, SCOM_H22_026, simplified transcription, CC BY-NC 4.0). A 72-year-old woman from Almázcara (Congosto, León), in 2004: «Antes a los padres se trataba de usté y había más respeto que hay ahora» ("In the old days you addressed your parents as usté, and there was more respect than there is now") (COSER-2637-02, CC BY-NC-ND 4.0). Is respect in the form of address? Write down your position and the best reason for the opposite one.

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